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The Yale Political Magazine

An Undergraduate Publication

Sexist Intolerance in the Women's Center
How the Center has betrayed women at Yale

The Demise of the Soviet Empire
An Interview with Edward Luttwak

The Problems of the Nuclear-Free Zone
Will ANZUS founder on New Zealand's anti-nuclear stance?

Book Review–Gorbachev's *Perestroika*
Do the reforms have any meaning?

Letters
Reacting to the new racism
Misunderstanding Misunderstanding Nicaragua?

VOLUME 11, NUMBER 1 ❦ NOVEMBER 1989

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We are the Yale Political Monthly, the oldest alternative college magazine in America. We were founded in 1979 by Robert Kagan and Joseph Rose. In 1988 we changed our name, but we remain dedicated to the principles of the original YPM. The purpose of this publication is to promote informed debate and reasoned discussion. We espouse no one set of beliefs, but rather print articles which represent a wide range of political opinion. The views expressed in the YPM are those of the contributors and do not necessarily reflect those of the staff of the magazine or of Yale University.

We encourage responses and will print all thoughtful and well-written letters with appropriate authorial response in the hope of stimulating continued dialogue on campus. All written material should be submitted to the Editor or mailed to the YPM. Students wishing to join the staff of the YPM should contact the Editor at 436-0136.

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VOLUME 11, NUMBER 1
NOVEMBER, 1989

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Letters

Sir–In their article "The New Racism at Yale," which appeared in the May 1989 issue of the *Yale Political Magazine*, Dale Carpenter and Roderyck Blake begin by stating their article's purpose: "to catalogue and deplore the incipient trends toward racial intolerance at Yale among individuals and gropups claiming to champion the interest of people of color." In light of such a noble cause, I was extremely surprised that Mr. Carpenter and Mr. Blake relied so heavily on name-calling and false presumptions to prove their points. For example, their reference to the "board of censorship" imposed by "racial purists" to attain "ideological control" shows a total misunderstanding of the context in which this "board of censorship" was suggested at last year's panel discussion ("People of Color and the White Press at Yale"). At the panel, heads of racial/ethnic organizations met with the heads of several undergraduate publications to present grievances particularly, the presentation of the names of people of color in articles about personal tragedy (compared to similar cases in which the names of Euro-Americans were kept anonymous), the thoughtless use of racial/ethnic terms, and the overall carelessness with which issues of race/ethnicity are handled in campus journals, mostly due to time and space restrictions. Because most of the publication heads were unaware of this perception (that they were being careless in ther references to people of color), they pressed the heds of the racial/ethnic organizations to suggest some way they could deal with this dilemma. It was under these circumstances that Maxim Thorne suggested an advisory board consisting of people of color to point out these specific instances of carelessness to the editorial boards. Let me stress, however, that Mr. Thorne himself saw his suggestion as *only one possibility* (the one that happened to be on the top of his head when the publication heads pressed him for an immediate response) and he was greatly dismayed when this suggestion soon became the central point upon which the publication heads chose to dwell. Unsurprisingly, by the end of the panel, many people felt (quite inaccurately) that Mr. Thorne's suggestion was in essence referring to a "board of censorship." The fact that Carpenter and Blake only mention this "board of censorhip" in passing (two sentences) is simply unfair. They pull this idea out of the context in which it was mentioned, choosing a sensationalist name that they coined themselves, in an attempt to prove the existence of a totally misconceived notion.

Furthermore, in the next paragraph, the authors' reference to *the yale Observer* as " disgusting...a rag which bills itself as 'an unofficial publication'" reflects a tone of undue hostility and arrogance. In their justification of such name-calling, they cite *one* poem from *one* issue, as if this singular piece (among the five issues, each consisting of 16-24 pages) could possibly reflect the nature of this publication. More importantly, though, their criticism of this one article is based on a false belief that the poem "Vanilla Princess" and the respoonse to it, "Vanilla Talks Back," were "cleverly" titled by the *Observer* editors. The facts: both articles were titled by their respective authors (a clarification that appeared in the 3 May 1989 issue of the *Observer*).

Riding upon their false premises they further attack the *Observer,* stating that "the reduction of a human being to an ice cream flavor echoes the destructive and demeaning labels discussed above." Point well taken. However, they not only take the title "Vanilla Talks Back" out of context of the actual piece, but they also fall victim to their own criticism, stating themselves in the next paragraph that "racism comes in all flavors." They *obviously* expected their readers to look beyond the face value of their reference to the "flavors" of

racism, yet they fail to extend this same courtesy to the fererences to "Vanilla" in the two above-mentioned articles.

Somewhere in their article, Mr. Blake and Mr. Carpenter have some relevant points. the issue of alienation within communities of Color is indeed an important issue that needs to be addressed. However, it is far from the "dirty secret [within] minority groups" that they call it. The "colorism" that flourishes within both communities of Color and the society at large has been a phenomenon of our society throughout history. Interracial couples have faced disdain from both white communities and communities of Color alike. Accusations of being "too white" abound, particularly within communities of Color. What Mr. Blake and Mr. Carpenter failed to recognize, though, is how accusation of being "too Black" or "too Asian" are *also* deeply interwoven into attitudes of "colorism" within communities of color.

Their self-coined term "racial purists" seems to originate more from their own personal resentments than from a clear-headed conception of the issues (especially since the people who use the labels "too white" are often the same people who use "too Black/Asian/Latino/etc.") Their implication of a "party line" (developed by these "racial purists," I suppose) only reinforces the popular misconception that racial/ethnic groups even have on coherent, representative ideology. (Would it not be ridiculous to perceive of all Euro-Americans as thinking alike, according to an all-encompassign Euro-American "party line" or ideology?) I agree that, "It is time for an end to stupid labels that dehumanize our brothers and sisters because their politics diverge from our orthodoxy." However, Carpenter and Blake hardly demonstrate a desire to follow their own philosophy on this account.

I simply do not understand their need to resort to such reactionary language—"cult of color," "racial purists," "party line," "champions of neo-racial intolerance." Through their reactionism, Mr. Carpenter and Mr. Blake only did a disservice to themselves and to the communities which they were trying to discuss. To base arguments upon inaccurate facts and name-calling only demonstrates bad journalism and plain disrespect. Especially in the midst of so many people (particularly concerned with issues of communities of color) who would be willing to clarify facts and discuss issues for the sake of such journalistic endeavors. All they had to do was poke around and ask. *—Alma Beck '92*

Mr. Blake Responds–"Discrimination" at Yale seems to mean black people being mistreated. Sometimes it means Hispanic people being mistreated. In fact, there are a few groups who are allowed to be "discriminated" against. The list is restricted, however. That's wrong. Clearly, discrimination can mean these things. It can also apply to other people who do not fall into these neat categories. Every rational person agrees with this. Unfortunately, this point escapes the groups most willing to call themselves "people of color" in many of their day-to-day activities. They lose sight of the general goal of ending all discrimination and focus only on ending discrimination against particular groups. The problem with this approach is that it almost inevitably exchanges one type of discrimination for another. But all discrimination is bad! Discrimination always and everywhere hurts the whole of society, whether it's "whites" discriminating against "blacks" or "blacks" against "whites." If we are sincere about ending discrimination, we must always remember to fight discrimination in its broadest sense, and not allow ourselves to adopt narrow definitions.

When a "person of color" gets into Yale, it is assumed by "white" racists that he or she got in because of his or her color. When a "person of color" gets a "C" on a paper, the assumption that the grade is based on race is every bit as racist. In order to address the problems of racism in a meaningful way and with any hope of solving them, we must avoid falling into simplistic views which blind us to reality. "People of color" are just as capable of deserving "C"s as "white" people, just as they may be equally deserving of "A"s. Part of problem with the CAAD was the double-edged racism it employed. On the one hand it tried to call attention to "white" racism at Yale, but it doing so, it raised racial tension and suspicion and helped bring us backward to when people were judged soley by their color.

The crux of our belief is that the continuous establishment of boundaries within the Yale community perpetuates suspicion and racial intolerance. We wrote the article to draw attention to this point. We are sorry that Miss Beck did not understand and we hope that we have clarified our point.

SIR–Vincent Mooney in: "Sister Cities: Misunderstanding Nicaragua" attacks people who visit a country (like the USSR, Cuba or Nicaragua) for a week or two and then claim to be experts when they speak or write on returning home. Mooney, while purporting to repudiate such behavior, himself manages a rather nasty indictment of the regime (which he visited for two weeks) *and* of Cuba which, presumably, he never visited. No matter, Mooney's indictments of Castro and the Sandinistas are mostly based on interviews with a few ex-patriates now living in Miami!!

Nor should we be deceived by Mooney's penitent admission of having deceived his fellow-students as to his true feelings before, and during his stay in Nicaragua. (Better admit than risk exposure afterwards?) Because of this confession, we might be inclined to think: Well, he is being honest with us now and we can believe all he writes. However, the *omissions* in Mr. Mooney's article are so glaring that they completely distort his presentation and reduce it to mere propaganda.

The first serious omission is: There is no historical perspective informing the article. Space constraints do not permit any account of Spanish (and on the Atlantic coast, British) invasions and exploitation. Suffice it to say that since 1801 the U.S. has invaded Nicaragua no fewer than fourteen times, actually keeping an occupying force there continuously from 1912-1933. It was U.S. support that enabled Somoza who arranged the murder of Sandino in 1934 to come to power. The Somozas enriched themselves and their cronies and many members of the National Guard, plundered, murdered and raped at will until the Sandinistas' triumph in 1979.

Far from initiating a police state, as Mooney insinuates, the Sandinistas began a program of profound social reform which was aimed at benefitting the poor and underprivileged, who had mostly been objects of scorn and opppression for 500.

The Sandinistas retained a mixed economy in Nicaragua and still do with (roughly) 60% privately owned property, 20% co-operatively owned and 20% (formerly owned by the Somozas) state co-owned. After coming to power the Sandinistas impressively achieved, with the help of thousands of students, a literacy campaign that reduced illiteracy from 50.3% to 12.9% of the adult population. Moreover, in the early years, the Sandinistas provided title to land to 45,000 *campesinos*, they provided 60,000 units of low-income housing and they provided about 500 health-care facilities (and education) for the poor who traditionally had suffered from inadequate health care. Mr. Mooney ignores all this and tells us: something is wrong with Nicarague; the country is in trouble; the *Sandinista* dictators are to blame. But Mooney's most glaring deception is his total failure to mention the U.S. backed *Contras* and the war they have carried on in Nicaragua for the past eight years.

This is unconscionable: since 1981 Nicaragua has been at war with a group of mercenary terrorists who are often led by former National Guardsmen (released, for compassionate reasons by the Sandinistas after coming to power. In many other countries they would have been shot). These mercenaries called *Contras* are not guerillas: for lack of internal or local support in Nicaragua they are primarily based in Honduras. They were recruited, trained, armed and fincanced by the U.S. (sometimes using Israel or Argentina as proxy, to allay criticism in the U.S.). The *Contras* showed their true metal [*sic*] by attacking schools, health-facilities, co-operatives, instead of seeking military engagements and they have conducted a so-called low intensity war which has claimed more than 50,000 Nicaraguan lives since 1981. This devastatng war has cost the Nicaraguan economy around 17 billion dollars (U.S.) and has forced diversion of money, time, personnel and resources from social reform to social-self-defense.

As regards the forth-coming elections in Nicaragua, all I will say is we must reject the Bush-Quayle-Mooney ploy of undermining the legitimacy of the elections before they are even held. The U.S. Library of Congress report, published 20 May 1989, comparing Nicaragua's election laws with those of other countries pronounced them democratic and fair. The UN is sending about 170 observers to oversee the elections and the Sandinistas, not only welcome foreign observers, but are anxious to see them come, so eager are they to show the world that they are committed to democratic elections *and* true social reform in their country of 3.6 million people, half of whom are under 21 years of age.

Why is the U.S. afraid of tiny Nicaragua? Is it perhaps because there we see true democracy aborning [*sic*] where the people not only have civil liberties but where they also have their socio-economic rights to food,

clothing, housing, education, health-care and cultural participation up-held. Is this a threat to the U.S. itself with its poverty, homelessness, inadequate health care and worsening racism? Perhaps.

(Rev) Paul Surlis
Assistant Professor of Social Ethics
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Jamaica, New York

Paul Surlis spent several weeks in Honduras and Nicaragua in 1986 and visited Nicaragua again in August 1989 to attend the anuual general meeting of the International League for Social Change in Adult Education of which he is a committee member.

MR. MOONEY RESPONDS–I fully admit that I did not give a historical perspective. My intent, however, was to discuss not the past but what is going on now in Nicaragua. Mr. Surlis mentions that the U.S. maintained a military force in Nicaragua from 1912-1933, yet does not explain that elections were held and a native civilian government existed during that time period.[1] Yet there was constant internal strife and armed struggle against each other and the U.S. The U.S. found out the hard way that democracy cannot be forced. I am not saying this justifies U.S. support for Somoza; I am only saying that the situation was complicated and certain options were not available that the U.S. would have liked to have had. People like Mr. Surlis sometimes try to portray the history of a country as a simple and straightforword condemnation of U.S. actions. An objective examination of U.S. foreign policy, however, reveals that it is not monolithic. It changes constantly from one president to the next and from one time period to the next. A discussion of history, however, was not my aim; I wanted to address the current situation in Nicaragua.

It is true that my interviews were mostly with refugees living in Miami. And I quoted a few New York Times articles with comments from refugees; for example, "Juan Calero, 26, fought in the 1979 insurrection and became a leader in the Sandinista Youth, a political organization. 'Eventually, I began realizing that this was not the democratic revolution that we had been promised, but that it was Communism,' Mr. Calero said."[2] Since then I ran across a case of a favorably disposed visitor becoming dissolutioned. Abbie Hoffman, radical anti-Vietnam War activist in the 60s, led a group to Nicaragua himself and wrote: "When I came here I was very sympathetic...This [minister of education Cardenal] turned me around. They are seeking to change legions of their children the way Hitler did. They are trying to create something like a Hitler Youth Corps." Hoffman was referring to the Minister's speech on the regime's determination to create a "new man."[3] Also, why is it that "the largest indigenous Communist insurgency in Southeast Asia"—the one in the Phillipines which has rejected the people's election of Corazon Aquino—has "internal divisions between the old-line Maoists, who favor political action, and the so-called Sandinistas, who favor militancy and armed struggle."[4] Is this because, as Paul Surlis states, the Sandinistas "are committed to democratic elections and true social reform?"

Mr. Surlis also points out that the economy is mixed. I did not deny that in my article. His view of the literacy campaign, however, I question. He does not address what one of the main people in the New Haven/León Sister City Project told me—that he is proud of the way the Sandinistas were able to combine literacy work with the teaching of socialism to the masses. As for the statistics,

> *At the conclusion of the [literacy] campaign, the FSLN announced that illiteracy had been reduced from over 50 percent to a mere 12 percent of the population, figures that have been repeated by North American admirers of the Sandinistas. But no one really knows whether that many people learned to read, or indeed if anyone did, as a result of the crusade, and the Nicaraguan government has not provided for any independent assesment. On the other hand, there is no doubt that the crusade enabled the Sandinistas to bring their political message to corners of the country that had previously little exposure to it. And Miguel Bolanos Hunter, a defector from State Security, says that the DGSE also used the campaign to establish a network of informers in remote areas where it had few or none.*[5]

The vicious attack upon the *Contras* is not surprising. It is true that the Sandinista-*Contra* war has severely hurt the Nicaraguan economy. Of course the fact that 11 of the 16 *Contra* leaders are former Sandinistas is never mentioned. The troops are mostly peasents (Surlis calls them "mercenary terrorists"), a fact that was acknowledged by one of the FSLN officials

we met with on my trip to Nicaragua. Why do from "6,000 to 10,000" *Contra* troops remain camped in Honduras?[6] They've received no military aid since 3 February 1988, and cannot fight without ammunition. They receive no salary, life in the camps is not easy, and their cause is considered lost by more enlightened observers. The *Contras* exist because there are Nicaraguans who dearly want freedom for their country and are willing to fight and die for it.

And that was the main point of my article—freedom. I came down harshly on the neighborhood block committees called CDSs (Committees to Defend the Sandinistas). We were told on our trip that the CDSs perform community service. However, every single refugee that I asked replied with anger that the CDSs are most basic controlling arm of the FSLN. A good summary of everything I have been told about the CDSs is given by Joshua Muravchik:

> *The CDS observes who comes and goes, who complains too demonstratively, who is active in church, and who reads the independent daily, La Prensa , rather than the approved newspapers. It distributes ration cards for scarce essential commodities, helps supervise draft registration and housing assignments, and provides letters of approval that are necessary for receiving passports, visas, licenses, business registration, loans, scholarships, and many jobs. It also provides manpower, when called upon, for the "turbas," the government organized "mobs" that assault and intimidate dissidents.*[7]

I stated in my article, "We were told that they do community service like helping with contracts or the literacy campaign. I believe that they have done that. But if that is all they do, why not call them Community Service Committees? Why does their name say that they defend the Sandinistas? Why not defend one of the other political parties, if in fact the Sandinistas are only a political party?" The neighborhood block committees in Cuba are called CDRs (Committees to Defend the Revolution). Mr. Surlis states that "the omissions in Mr. Mooney's article are so glaring that they completely distort his presentation and reduce it to mere propaganda." Yet he himself never mentions what was probably the strongest point of my article—the overwhelming influence of the CDSs! How could he assert that Nicaragua is not akin to a "police state" and not even address the CDS? I found this to be the most frustrating aspect of his letter.

As far as the elections are concerned, I do not know what will happen. I did point out that many Nicaraguans related to me that the prevalent hunger, malnutrition, and near-starvation conditions are far worse than than at any other time in their memory. In fact, a recent study "prepared by an international team of experts at the request of President Daniel Ortega" states that "the actual buying power of workers' salaries...has plummeted by more than 92 percent...the country's gross domestic product has fallen to roughly $300 a year [which is] less than the comparable figure of $330 a year for Haiti, long the hemisphere's poorest nation."[8] People tend to credit or blame the government in power for the economic state of a country, and in fact a Nicaraguan told me while I was there that the majority of Nicaraguans hope for a change in government in 1990. I asked how the person knows "majority," and the response was, "Because I am Nicaraguan, I talk with people, I see how they act and what they say, and they are not happy with the current situation." All I said in my article was that I find it "almost inconceivable that in these conditions the Sandinistas could win in a truly open, pluralistic election. Nevertheless, people who strenuously want to beleive in the Sandinistas will probably rationalize their victory somehow in 1990." Maybe the Sandinistas will allow the opposition candidate, Violeta Chamorro, to be President if she wins, much as has happened in Poland. But this is entirely up to the Sandinistas. Nevertheless, as in Poland, the strucure and apparatus of state control is already set up, and the use of this apparatus will determine the future of Nicaragua, no matter how good the election laws might be.

A good friend of mine has an uncle who ran for Vice President of the Communist Party, USA. He says his family never believed the stories of Stalin's purges—much less any other negative information about Russia—until Kruschev's 1950 speech when he admitted them. We all must struggle to keep an open, honest mind. We must not shut off clear, convincing information if we believe we see it, now matter how strongly we believe in socialism, or, in the case of military dictators, capitalism. Oppression is oppression, whether the regime is on the right or the left. And that was the main point of my article.

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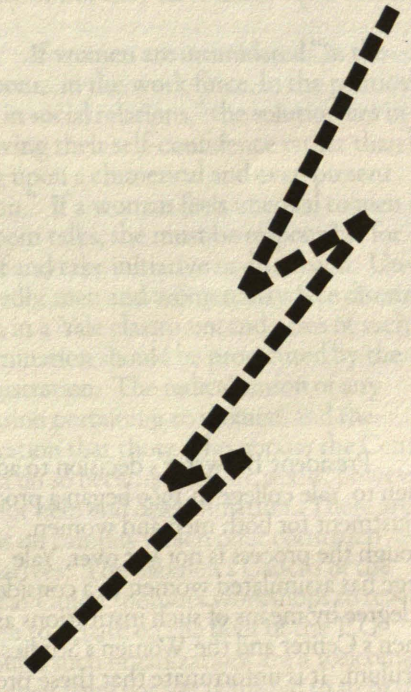
[1] Walter LaFeber, *Inevitable Revolutions*, p.64.
[2] Roberto Suro, "New Curbs Will Not Stop Is, Border Aliens Say," *New York Times*, 27 Febuary 1989, p. A14.
[3] Quoted in "Abbie pal sours on Red regime", *New York Post*, 1 January 1985.
[4] Steven Erlanger, "After 20 Years, Phillipine Insurgency Falters," *New York Times*, 21 October 1989, p. A1.
[5] Joshua Muravchik, *Nicaragua's Slow March to Communism*, p. 12.
[6] Mark A. Uhlig, "Dispute Over Panel Highlights Difficulty of Disbanding the *Contras*", *New York Times*, 21 October 1989, p. A5.
[7] Muravchik, p. 10.
[8] Mark A. Uhlig, "Nicaraguan Study Reports Economy in Drastic Decline," *New York Times*, 26 June 1989, p. A1.



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Are the *Contras* Finished?
Can there be free elections under the Sandinistas?
What role should America play?

On 16 November 1989
These questions will be answered
in SSS 114 by

Arturo Cruz Jr.

in the first speech of the 1989 YPM speakers series,
Against the Grain

10

Sexist Intolerance in the Women's Center

Kimberly Kessler

The Women's Center has been overrun by a radical ideology which represents only a small portion of the women at Yale

President Brewster's decision to admit women to Yale college in 1969 began a process of adjustment for both men and women. Although the process is not yet over, Yale College has assimilated women to a considerable degree by means of such institutions as the Women's Center and the Women's Studies curriculum. It is unfortunate that these programs have been overrun by a radical ideology which represents only a small portion of the women at Yale.

"The Yale Women's Center seeks to initiate and promote activities which heighten awareness of our history, culture and concerns as women in the communities of Yale, New Haven, and the world." The Women's Center, however, has lost interest in simply heightening awareness and has turned to the active support of radical, reverse sexist philosophies, neglecting the views of most Yale men and women. The majority of women at Yale neither hate men, nor seek vengeance for past injustices. The Women's Center exclusively supports feminist solutions to problems of women and sytematically opposes the consideration of other views. The Center's characterization of pro-life advocates as anti-feminist, and therefore sexist, is a case in point.

Two years ago, the Women's Center rejected the application of Yale Students for Life for residency within the Center, arguing that the students in the pro-life group were mostly male. The fact that there was only one man in Students for Life at the time did not seem to affect their position. They opposed the application simply because the pro-life position conflicts with the stance held by the officers of the Center. One of the Center's coordinators, Rhiannon Patterson, bore this out:

The political efforts to restrict abortion rights...are part of the reactionary backlash of the last decade against social transformations. The rapid polarization of the nation concerning abortion shows the conflict between a dynamic movement toward gender equality and the empowerment of women, and tremendous fear among many men and women of what such an empowerment means. (Yale Herald, *8 Sep 1989*)

Miss Patterson believes that women in the pro-life movement fear empowerment. By equating the pro-life position with cowardice, Miss Patterson helps to prolong the system of sexist intolerance she so vehemently decries. It is unfortunate that this philosophy has permeated the struggle between YSFL and the Women's Center.

In the fall of 1987, the Women's Center re-drafted its statement of purpose, broadening the scope of the organization, hoping to incorporate more women into its programs. The YSFL's resultant request for residency led the officers of the Center to amend this new purpose, requiring the organizations housed in the Center to advocate reproductive freedom, thus excluding the pro-life group. Instead of offering a forum for diverse opinions on women's issues, the Women's Center established a narrow political agenda which undermined its own ideals, as expressed in the Statement of Purpose (written in the Spring of 1987). The Center's refusal to accommodate diverse political beliefs in accordance with its purported philosophy is a living example of the single-minded intolerance the Center espouses.

Kimberly Kessler is a Freshman in Saybrook and Managing Editor of the YPM.

The Women's Center has not invited Yale Women for Life to participate in the twentieth anniversary celebrations. Melanie Oxhorn, Vice President of Yale Students for Life, stated that "the Center tends to assume that a woman 'cannot be liberated and a feminist and still project a pro-life stance.' (*The Yale Herald*, 22 Sep 1989)"

The radical feminist positions held by the Women's Action Coalition serve only to heighten conflict and alienation at Yale. The *Herald* reports a Timothy Dwight freshman's experience at the Women's Action Coalition meeting he attended: "The atmosphere seemed to foster a subliminal discrimination against those who are male and definitely against those who hold opinions that are not held by the WAC." A comic strip entitled "the dRuNk kIds" printed in the same issue satirized the reverse sexist attitudes prevelant in the organization. Several drunk male college students are screaming sexually explicit lyrics and dancing to loud guitar accompaniment on their stereo in the first two frames. The last frame depicts a group of women and a hooded Death figure carrying picket signs saying "Our Torment" and "I Hate Men," knocking on the door. The heading reads: "The Women's Center is *not* amused."

The Center's statement of purpose reads: "We work toward a world without discrimination in which all women create, act, and achieve freely—in the classroom, on the playing field, in the work force, in the political arena, in social relations and in our personal lives." The Center's own methods, however, serve to perpetuate discrimination on the basis of sex and destroy any hope of attaining their lofty goals. Discrimination cannot be ended either by reverse discrimination or by revolutionary, fanatical dogmatism. Men must know that women wish to be treated as equals, not superiors, and that women do not seek compensation for past discrimination, or they will see attempts to attain equality as attempts to disenfranchise men. Instead, women must seek recognition for their own accomplishments. Society should not lower its standards to accommodate inferior works merely because they provide an "alternate perspective" or an opportunity for tokenism. The western literary canon should include those works of western literature which have molded modern thought, regardless of the sex, race, or religion of the authors. Feminists frequently argue that women must be equally represented in all fields, whether or not they have made equal contributions.

If women are intimidated "in the classroom,...in the work force, in the political arena, in social relations," the solution lies in improving their self-confidence rather than by calling upon a chimerical and ever-present "sexism." If a woman feels unequal to men in classroom talks, she must be responsible for herself and take initiative in discussion. Undoubtedly, men and women may face discrimination in a Yale classroom, and cases of such discrimination should be prosecuted by the administration. The radicalization of any discussion pertaining to women, and the implication that those who oppose the Center's dogma do so because they are sexist, however, does not help end discrimination. There are groups on campus which offer constructive alternatives. The Women's Caucus of the Political Union sponsors workshops to teach women to debate on the floor of the P.U. Although such organizations are a welcome relief, they have not yet managed to stem the tide of radical feminist dogma which pours from the Women's Center.

The incessant promotion of "non-gender-specific" vocabulary endeavors to change thought by changing language. These verbal contortions reek of Orwellian "Newspeak," seeking to control thought by limiting vocabulary. "Humans" or "people" may be substituted for "men," but such changes are merely cosmetic. "Freshperson" exemplifies Yale neuterspeak. The *Herald's* 22 September picture poll revealed that most Yale students consider the term "stupid" and "silly." Idiomatic modifications restructure words, not thought, and "non-gender-specific" language creates tension where none previously existed.

The Women's Studies curriculum gives academic respectability to the Women's Center by providing an academic justification for the study of feminism. The prerequisite for a Women's Studies major is Women's Studies 295a, "Introduction to Women's Studies and Feminist Thought." The course description reads:

Focus on the manifold issues of the contemporary feminist movement; analysis of attempts to explain and change women's status; exploration of feminist theory. Examination encompasses multi-ethnic perspectives on women's experience in America, and cross-cultural comparisons with similar movements in

These verbal contortions reek of Orwellian "Newspeak," seeking to control thought by limiting vocabulary

other countries.

The major focuses on feminism, not the development of the role of women historically. If the curriculum incorporated a similar program of Men's Studies, feminists would undoubtedly object, citing the implicit chauvinism. Only the reverse sexism prevalent at Yale shields the Women's Studies program from this allegation.

The Women's Center houses many worthwhile and essential organizations, such as Response and the Eating Concerns Outreach. The Center and the Women's Studies program, unfortunately, preach a radical feminist dogma which serves to polarize the Yale community. The prospectus for the Women's Center reads:

The Yale Women's Center is dedicated to improving the status of women at Yale, in New Haven, and in the world. We don't have a strict ideology. All of the women involved in the center find different ways of expressing their feminism, and all of them choose different methods of working towards change.

Yet, the politics of the Women's Center are monolithic, doctrinaire, and intolerant. The status of women has been only hurt by the attempt to indoctrinate all women into the struggle to overthrow what is painted as an agressive, intolerant, male-dominated world. The struggle between Yale Students for Life and the Center demonstrates precisely the absence of the open-mindedness the Center claims to espouse. Perhaps the Women's Center has spent so long staring in a mirror that it has lost touch with the real world. There is an important and constructive role for the Center to play if it can only give up its long-cherished dogma, abandon ideology, and help women seeking equality, not vengeance, in the Yale community.

The injustice of keeping ROTC off campus
How Yale discriminates against those who seek to serve their country

Engage Seth Cropsey,
Principle Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense
for Special Operations & Low Intensity Conflicts

at 8:00 pm, 30 November 1989 in SSS 114

The Demise of the Soviet Empire
An Interview with Edward Luttwak

Has the structure of the structure of the Soviet Union's armed forces changed along with Soviet rhetoric?

The structure has not changed, but the very intense discussions going on within the armed forces, we know that they are having furious debates about how to change the structure of their forces. Of course, this is only from the numerous Soviet military publications, most of which are really professional publications that cannot be used for disinformation. It is clear is that there is no serious resistance to the idea of reducing their traditional forces: the tank divisions, the motor-rifle divisions, the new artillery divisions, and so on. There is also no serious resistance to decreasing the number, but there is much debate over how the structure should be changed, or the reduced structure should be changed. Although there is a consensus on the reduction of those conventional forces, that does not mean that the Soviet military are enthusiastically promoting the reduction of Soviet military power.

In the same magazines that contain these doctrinal discussions, which we now see cited in our own journals as evidence, there are also other articles which many Americans always choose not to cite. These are the ones that outline the shape of future military power, so that the Soviet armed forces have not yet changed. That should not be shocking, because it takes time. The change is not merely a reduction. It can be described as a reduction in the conventional formats, designed to liberate space, resources, etc. for novel formats. They're novel indeed—what the Soviets call "reconnaissance-strike complexes." In this regard it's important to recall that the Soviet military are much less wedded to the preservation of established forms than our own. The Western military, unless pressured from the outside, will lovingly preserve the formats, weapons-systems, and platforms they already have. This bureaucratic proclivity is extremely well documented. It is the Soviet armed forces which have been bold innovators, in spite of their permanent technological inferiority. In 1940-41, the Soviet Union was technologically backward compared to Germany, but they did invent the medium battle tank, the T-34, which just happened to be the only weapon of decisive importance in that particular fighting. In the 1950s, when the United States was embarked on a massive program to build up bomber forces, the Air Force was most inventive in coming up with reasons why the ballistic missile was not worthwhile, but the Soviet Union [was developing the ballistic missile]. It was the Soviet Navy that came up with the gas-turbine as a means of propulsion, which changed a lot of things below deck, and then with the anti-ship missile, instead of the artillery battle, which changed almost everything above the deck. In the current generation [of weapons], which is neither land nor sea or air but transcends all three, it is an innovation which in effect would take out the core of the army, navy, and air force and replace it with these reconnaissance-strike complexes, which are arrays of satellites, possibly high-altitude aircraft platforms, which contain all sorts of sensors to acquire targets, and

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Dr. Edward Luttwak is currently at the Center for Strategic and International Studies in Washington. This interview was conducted by John Kuszewski and Frederick Kagan in October of 1989.

which would then transmit this target information to bases which would launch missiles. The idea is [to have] unmanned vehicles that would fly around looking down until they recognize something and hit it. All of this requires a type of technology in which we are more advanced. But the reality is that our military complexes are not interested in destroying their own institutional base to create these new forces, but [the Soviets] are doing it. We should not be suspicious of Soviet intentions because Soviet intentions are consistent with this relaunching of military power. I may note parenthetically that if you no longer have an ideology that can suppress the people in territory that you have conquered, it behooves you to have a form of military power that does not rely on territorial conquest.

It seems that the Israelis have been pushing ahead in the technology of remotely piloted vehicles far more than we have. Do they share this sense of innovation with the Soviet Union?

Yes. For obvious reasons the armed forces institutions in Israel and the Soviet Union have bureaucratic proclivities, but there is a difference in how far these proclivities are allowed to determine what they do. We have a long tradition of extreme inwardness and bureaucratization, more so than other countries. The Soviets have less of this tradition, and the Israelis less than that. And that is why the Israeli air force, many years ago, without being well placed from a resource point of view went into the RPV business. This is not simply an Israeli invention—the technology in question was very much developed in the United States. One of the early impulses to the Israeli program came from a developer of RPVs, who went to the Israelis after failing to persuade anyone here to take it seriously. But we are now going beyond the RPV to the unmanned air vehicle, which can be thought of as a machine which flies around, not controlled by a distant operator but, rather, autonomously identifies targets and attacks them using image recognition or other sensor recognition.

The cold war is most definitely over.

How long would it be before the Soviets are able to build that sort of thing technologically?

The unmanned vehicle is very far for the Soviets. The air robot that roams the battlefield is very far for them, and very likely the Israelis will be the first to have it. They already demonstrated a mock-up of it at the Paris air show. The problem is primarily one of recognition. The demonstration showed a tube protruding at a certain angle from behind the barrier and the recognition device looked at the tube, identified it as a tank of which this was the gun barrel and then went and attacked it. On the other hand the Soviets are much closer to the realization of reconnaissance-strike complexes. They do have many satellites, as we know, including very powerful nuclear-energized radar satellites, which cover the oceans, look down, and see any piece of metal. Our navy relentlessly practices operations which minimize the use of communications, but if you are a very large metal object on the surface of the sea, you will not escape Soviet radar. Instead of having a navy to meet a navy, you have a radar which spots the navy and relays the information back. Then you fire a ballistic missile which gets to that locality within a maximum of twenty five minutes. A ship that does thirty knots can do fifteen or twenty knots in that time, conceivably, or it might not move at all, so the missile cannot be a simple inertially guided warhead falling down - once it gets to the general target area it has to be able to maneuver. It needs no sensors because the reconnaissance-strike system's sensors can feed it target data, but it does need to be able to maneuver. They are much closer to that, for naval purposes first of all. For land purposes, let's say the European setting, things are easier, for the interval between the initial launch and final descent is shorter. But, in any case, if you were to follow the US special journals on the subject, you would have the evidence of Soviet reductions and discussions of reductions, but whether these discussions presage real reductions would not be clear. These journals also contain articles that explain why the Soviet military would go along with it, but they speak as though the matters were not related. When the question is raised, they would answer that this is just talk, because the Soviets do not have the technology. That overlooks the ability of the Soviet system to focus, to overcome generic inferiority to achieve particular capabilities.

Is the cold war over?

Yes. The cold war is most definitely over. The cold war was the product of the existence of two very powerful, non inter-

communicating great powers which were inhibited from doing the normal thing, i.e. fighting a war because of nuclear weapons. The two great powers now have increasingly to worry about other powers around them. That's one change. The second change is that they are intercommunicating. Primarily because they recognize that it is advantageous to communicate in the light of the relationship with all these other powers around them. Thirdly the inhibiting power of nuclear weapons is declining. If you make a linear projection of denuclearization you get a situation where war becomes possible again. So, I think the basic conditions of the cold war have changed.

What are these other powers that have arisen?

Well, they are different powers for different purposes. The United states has to contend with Japan in the context of international negotiations about finance. It has to contend with Latin American countries in terms of domestic problems like drugs and immigration. It has to contend with Europe in terms of trade relations and so on. The Soviet Union for its part wants to contend with Western Europe in a different way, wants to deal directly with Western Europe, and the Soviets know that you cannot communicate with the Western Europeans seriously if you don't communicate with the United States. The West Europeans will only go so far in dealing with the Soviet Union. They will not go very far if Moscow doesn't talk to Washington. Those times when American diplomacy has been anxious about Europeans going ahead with it, actually the Europeans were not be willing to go very far with the Soviets.

Do you think now would be a good time to negotiate another SALT treaty?

Well, nobody has ever actually explained why it is a particularly good idea to limit nuclear weapons. Nuclear weapons never did harm to anybody. It may be a good idea because nuclear weapons, although they continue not to do any harm, may no longer provide the benefit they once did. Even if one takes a sort of Olympian view, one has to conclude that the superpowers were able to start new nuclear weapons programs when they felt insecure in lieu of territorial seizures which were the standard remedy of great powers of the past when they felt insecure. Nuclear weapons served as a less harmful substitute for that kind of stuff. If you take a less Olympian view, nuclear weapons have certainly served the United States extremely well because with all the inhibitions and all the deficiencies at the level of American power, in a country that doesn't have a special operations capability, doesn't have a covert action capability, has enormous reluctance about getting involved in wars and all these other things, nuclear weapons served as a wonderful substitute. Whatever other problems you may have with the military bureaucracy, for example their refusal to contingency plan wars that might really happen, you don't have that problem with nuclear weapons. They've always been willing to plan for the all-out nuclear attack, because that, from a bureaucratic point of view, is the only safe war. Nobody is going to criticize you in the aftermath.

How has the performance of the Soviet economy changed since Gorbachev's ascent to power?

The Soviet economy, as everybody records, has been deteriorating, and the reason is that there is something worse than a bureaucratically controlled economy: a bureaucratically controlled economy in which particular bits are liberalized. This is the general proposition of the "second best" economy. There's actually a formal proof that if you move away from an optimal system to a sub-optimal system, optimizing components does not ensure a second best outcome. A good metaphor would be to imagine a system in which everybody has to drive on the left like in Sweden or England and then they decide to change it to have trucks drive on the right—that's essentially what's happened. Another aspect of it originates from Gorbachev himself: He's very skillful and thoughtful in politics, foreign policy, and so on, but in economic matters he suffers from an extreme case of legalism. He studied jurisprudence—the illusion that you can solve concrete problems, real oppositions of forces, real needs, and so on, by passing legislation—in Moscow University. So it's not surprising, for example, that when he heard people were drinking too much, he passed a law cutting vodka production 75%. Not a law building cafes, entertainment places giving people something to do at night, no, a 75% cut. Then he's amazed to discover

Nuclear war is the only safe war—nobody's going to criticize you in the aftermath

that sugar is disappearing from all the shops. He's the only person in the Soviet Union over the age of three who didn't know that you can make alcohol out of sugar. Sugar is something unimportant in Western societies, but in the Soviet Union, very strongly sugared tea is a great source of comfort to people, and the disappearance of sugar caused a tremendous hardship. So then he puts into place a detailed sugar rationing system. That, while he's supposedly liberalizing, creates a whole new system of controls. However, the moonshine industry is disturbed enough that jam, confiture, and marmalades disappear from the shelves. Again, these are not important items in the Western diet any more, but in the USSR, it's another great hardship. And so it's been going on at every level.

Another example is the decline of bread quality. One of the comforts in the Soviet Union was always the availability unlimited amounts of excellent bread. In the last few years the quality of bread has become abysmally bad because the grain doesn't get to the bakeries in time—it sprouts en route. Recently, most of the bread-making grain has been imported. Gorbachev imported a lot of bread-making grain, but by the time it got to the mills, it had sprouted as well. Why? Because they could not transship it fast enough. And the reason is that before Gorbachev, transshipment was accomplished by a system of bribery by the ship captains, to clear out quickly from the port and get back to business, to the port people, who would hand the money over to the railway people, who in turn would bribe anyone who brought a hopper to the railway station. Bribes went all the way down the railway line and sucked in hoppers all the way from Vladivostok to the Black Sea ports. Gorbachev had Brezhnev's railway minister arrested for bribery, and the result is that there is absolutely no known way of inducing hoppers to travel down the trans-Siberian line to get to the Black Sea. There's neither a market mechanism or a none-market mechanism. Stalin's method was you would list the number of hoppers that had to arrive in Odessa and he'd shoot people if they didn't. Gorbachev is neither shooting them nor rewarding them, so you now have dysfunctions like this across the Soviet Union. Gorbachev comes in again and passes a regulation essentially removing the obligation of producing specific items on industrial entities. If you're in the metal tray business, they used to tell you to make fifty tons of trays. Today they say that you can produce whatever you want, so they're focusing production on particular items, making others unavailable. For example, one of the items that industry decided not to produce was soap powder. They produce another chemical instead. The result is that soap powder disappears. In fact, one of the striking miners' demands [last Summer] was for soap powder, another was for jam, another was for wheat. In fact, the list of the specific items that the miners requested is very revealing about what's happening in the Soviet economy. The average Soviet citizen, frankly, doesn't know what the world is talking about. The whole world is celebrating the progression of his leaders, but from his point of view, they're looking back on the Brezhnev period with nostalgia. Life was much easier.

Is this economic situation going to reach a breaking point? At some point will it get so bad that Gorbachev's position will become untenable?

No. This situation has already brought about unprecedented mass strikes and is fueling localist and nationalist [activities], but none of it means that Gorbachev's position becomes untenable. One of the reasons his position is tenable is because he's the only guy who has a license to drive the sled when there are wild horses. Perestroika has wild horses. The other leaders feel they couldn't drive it—they'd be forced into the immediate choice between repression and chaos. A certain level of trouble is therefore helpful to Gorbachev.

So he has no real competition, no one waiting in the wings to take his place?

Not now. Any competitor would want him to go much further down this route before striking. Anyone who knocks him off by now has to be one of his friends—his enemies by now are all out. A friend who wants his job and decides he wants to run on a law-and-order platform, has to wait until there's more trouble. And more trouble is coming. So until then, here you are.

Do you think the Baltic states will secede any time soon?

I think they're going to increase the effective autonomy which is already coming

into place through *perestroika.* For example, one dimension of *perestroika* weakens the ministries in Moscow. A shoe factory in Estonia is less controlled by the ministry of shoemaking in Moscow, more by the Estonian authorities. The momentous development is that the Estonian collaborating class, either by conviction or by responding to political pressure, has become autonomous. There are many things in the present situation which can be exploited to increase de facto autonomy, and that's what they will do. And that's why one of the biggest, most difficult demands is in the military area, where they cannot increase their autonomy. The Soviet army even refuses to allow them to have regional conscription, much less end it entirely. Interestingly, the Byelorussians joined that particular bandwagon, saying that they also want regional conscription. This has to do with the rising problem of the Central Asians. Russians don't want to be in the same bunk with them. In effect, what you now have in the Soviet Union is a situation where Swedes and Turks are conscripted into the same barracks.

Does the Red Army still practice distant deployment of conscripts?

Yes, it is still the rule, but it is not only Soviet. This is the traditional Russian practice and the standard practice of the continental armies. Because of the national issue, the Russian practice is very close to the Hapsburg's in Austria-Hungary, which had the Italian conscripts in Bohemia and the Bohemians in Italy.

What is the going to happen in Eastern Europe? Are they going to be allowed to go?

The Soviets are very pleased that if what is happening is inevitable, that it is happening in the way that it is. It's the Poles, who are wedged in, that are making the clean break with communism, and the Hungarians, who are not wedged in, that are not making the clean break with communism—the communist party itself going into business as the party of reform. There's been a more subtle transformation in Hungary, so that in two, three, or four years' time, when East Europeans look around and ask how the non-Communists have succeeded, they will have to look at the Poles. The Soviets believe that the Hungarians will be able to succeed, and that the Poles will fail. They're convinced that the Poles will fail.

Economically?

Yes. They believe that the Poles have the capacity of slipping on all the banana peels of history in their path. It's a very serious Soviet presumption. That's why they can tolerate the clean break, and the advertising of this non-communism.

Will the Poles slip?

I don't know. In order for them not to slip, they will have to confront some of the unacknowledged realities of the present situation. One of them is that there's some good in any system, even if it's part of a larger evil. For example, a whole lot of Poles have not had to work for their entire working lives. Or they've been able to work in a kind of happy situation where there were many goals to be pursued, like how one could divert production to private purposes, how one could carry on political activity in the guise of economic activity, how one could have social life. Warsaw, in many ways, was a city where a lot of people had a lot of fun. Nobody's starving in Poland, so what we're talking about is improving the standard of living. Unfortunately, the model for the proper standard of living is Northern Europe, and the Polish economy is not like the Northern European economy, which is really based on a whole lot of people routinely working extremely hard with a great deal of capital and with extreme skill. The Polish and the Swedish railway workers are differentiated by the amount of capital stock each carries on his head, so to speak, and by the kind of effort they're willing to put in. Polish railway workers visit the Swedish, German, or Dutch railway machine shops and they're amazed by the kind of things that go on. How people spend hours draped all over the machinery they're fixing, and getting up completely exhausted, having focused on this repair job. The Poles can repair too, but they don't. These things must first be recognized. The Hungarians don't have this problem because in the last few years, the communist economy has coexisted with a private sector that has already absorbed the meaning of a private sector, which is that you work very hard.

The Soviets believe that the Poles have the capacity of slipping on all the banana peels of history in their path

What will happen to East Germany?

I cannot predict what will happen to East Germany, but I'll talk about specific phenomena. One phenomenon in East Germany is that East Germany is the only country in Eastern Europe whose politics are only governed by the signals in Moscow. Both the policies of the government and public attitudes are made in obedience or reaction to the signals from Moscow. The old joke really holds true: There was no revolution in Germany because somebody put up a sign saying revolution is verboten. The East Germans have always been in close proximity with West Germans. They've always seen the enormous difference in standard of living and freedom, but they didn't do anything about it on a mass level until somebody put up a sign in Moscow saying "protest is allowed." Essentially, the East Germans are the troops, their government is the corporals and sergeants, and the officers are the Russians. So when the officers say it's OK to go on leave, they want to go on leave, and they ask why the corporals in between are preventing them. It's as if in 1989, some East German Christopher Columbus had sailed west and found West Germany. They always knew West Germany was there: they watched the TV programs, heard the radio stations, travelled back and forth, but they're acting as if they just discovered West Germany. They're behaving exactly as the joke has it. As long as the officers are still saying you can go on leave, this tension will not be resolved. And it can be resolved in two ways: the NCOs start toeing the line, or the officers change theirs.

Unfortunately, the supply of communists has really dried out in recent years.

It seems to me that one of the things we're looking at is sort of the dissolution of the Warsaw Pact as an effective alliance. What does this mean? Can the Soviets really allow this from a military, political, or economic standpoint? After all, the East German economy used to keep the Soviets with toothpaste. Now they're not giving them toothpaste any more.

So long as the schools and the state-sponsored youth culture could turn out a supply of communists that would go into the armed forces, the Warsaw Pact had a military capability. In an armored invasion, the formations that go along with the flow of forces do not need necessarily to be highly motivated. They add to the mass of the action even if they're just tagging along with no combat morale at all. From the defender's point of view, he has to administer firepower to those worthless formations as well, and their weight, ability to occupy terrain, and create momentum is the same. As long as you had a decent supply of communists, you had more than that in the Warsaw Pact. Unfortunately, the supply of communists has really dried out in recent years. In the age groups of forty and above, you still have communists, but they're going to be around for only a few more years. Now you are left with an inert mass. In Hungary, the government can't order its forces to attack. So if Hungary were to leave the Warsaw Pact, declare itself neutral, it would essentially be a de jure recognition of something that has already happened.

What does this mean for Soviet military strategy at this point? That renders their traditional plan for the invasion of Western Europe absolutely inoperable.

No, it doesn't, because East Germany and Poland are still firmly within the Warsaw Pact, and they still would implement their orders. Remember that they don't need to be highly motivated to contribute the weight of their forces to a Soviet operation. All they have to do is obey administratively, moving out of barracks, moving down the road and travelling in the general direction.

What if Poland declares itself neutral?

That would render the strategy inoperable. The current force structure that the Soviets are willing to diminish cannot function without the Polish railways. The Polish railways and railway workers were vital to Nazi Germany's campaign against the Soviet Union. They carried the German troops eastward before they carried the Soviet troops westward, so the Soviets are justifiably nervous about their reliability. However, the Soviet development of reconnaissance-strike complexes would make the Soviet Army independent of the Polish railways. By their very interest in this research, the Soviets are giving de facto recognition of the decline in the operability of their conventional forces. It's another part of the collapse of the authority of the whole ideology. I would in fact offer the general proposition that Marxism may be a lousy way of doing economics, or doing

culture, but it's a great way of doing military forces.

I would think that this would upset the military establishment of the Soviet Union, which, after all, has typically been rational and scientific in its planning. They have arrived at a force structure which is rational, scientific, and based on all these facts, and now they're being told to dump it for political purposes.

No. Several years ago, before *perestroika*, the Soviet military began to recognize that the situation was changing, and that their force structure would have to change with it. That's why they started developing an alternative format [the reconnaissance-strike complexes] that doesn't rely on territorial control. In theory, if you build a reconnaissance-strike system with its long range missiles and so on, you could have the same amount of military control even if you were down to the old Moscow gubernia—Poland wouldn't matter at all. The Soviet military has seen the value of this for years.

So this reduction in conventional strength is like the one which occurred under Khrushchev for the purposes of coming out with a smaller army that's better equipped to deal with the realities of the present day.

That's right, but Gorbachev's change is much larger. Under Khrushchev, the Red Army went from 5.7 million troops to 3.6—1.9 million down. He took out the artillery and replaced it with nuclear systems. In the Brezhnev era, the Soviet army was denuclearized and the artillery was rebuilt from the beginning. However, beginning under Marshal Ogarkov, they saw that the armored formation, sustained by long lines of communication, cannot operate in Western Europe any more. The first remedy was to go over to blitzkrieg, super-blitzkrieg and OMGs in order to knock over NATO so quickly that it doesn't matter what Polish railway workers do. Then they decided that this was not a good idea.

When was this?

In the mid-1970s. They began to talk about operational maneuver groups—a mode of warfare, what you might call a blitzkrieg-pass. You fling in lots of helicopter units in a surprise attack and disrupt the entire NATO defense system before it can really start going. There are numerous problems with that. But they were trying to fix these problems one by one, coming up with ad hoc remedies at the level of the artillery, the helicopters, or the armored forces. Like, for example, nuclear weapons. Oh, dear,there are all these nuclear weapons, so they developed SPETSNAZ forces to take them out. While all this was proceeding people at the general staff academy were saying, well it's real nice that all the people at the artillery academy are working on all these clever solutions, but actually great political, ideological changes are going a different way. So they said, instead of fixing the thousand problems, let's go to a different mode of warfare, and that's when they started talking about reconnaissance-strike complexes. Now we see something I find very impressive—the willingness of the military establishment to cash in its existing forces to position itself for the future. And it's all very consistent because the improvement of East-West relations gives them much more access to Western technology.

So the political aspects of perestroika *assist the military aspects by bringing in the technology.*

Facilitating access to technology. Conventional force reductions themselves liberate resources and the improvement of East-West relations which this brings about and of which this is an expression improves access to technology. They don't need very much because they have been able to produce pretty impressive stuff on the base of their existing technology, which they've also been able to supplement through intelligence. On the low base of Soviet technology, they were able to build a pyramid, narrower and narrower, but focused through specialization, and they got to be very close to where we are in certain areas. That's why they were always just below us instead of being way below us. With *perestroika* they start getting pipelines down from where we are, so now the technology access is almost the same. So now you have an equality of application. Essentially, they retain their advantage and we lose ours. So if you're a Soviet military man of a progressive cast of mind, you're quite pleased.

So what should we be doing about this?

the military establishment to cash in its existing forces to position itself for the future

Set up a water-cooled, belt-fed machine gun in the corridors of the Pentagon supplied liberally with ammunition, and challenge this holy cow called readiness. Cut readiness. Right now, we're cutting back on R & D, innovation, and the acquisition of new systems, to spend all our money on the upkeep of existing forces under the slogan of readiness. Instantaneous war readiness implies nothing about being ready to fight a war—in fact, as we know from Panama, in some ways we are unready to fight a war—we are not willing to fight a war. But it does have the bureaucratic advantage of maintaining existing forms polished and embellished. We have to stop all that and recognize that, ever since 1945, we have had the cultural, political, economic, and, more and more, the ideological initiative, but we have never had the strategic initiative. We always have to do what the Soviets do: if they want cold it's cold, if they want hot, it's hot. And they decide to go ballistic, we have to ballistic. Their navy decides to go missile navy, we have to go missile navy. So we should accept this reality and we should look at what the Soviets are doing. And the correct answer to someone setting up a reconnaissance-strike complex is to set up systems that can elude these sensors to attack the base of these systems. Stealthy, concealed systems would seem the logical military answer: if you start taking out things, I will go after your reconnaissance-strike complex. If somebody goes into the reconnaissance-strike business , there's no use attacking his tanks because his tanks are there to repress Poles or put down students or something—they're not there to win wars. He relies on disarming you with his reconnaissance-strike complexes, so the correct answer to that is to disarm his reconnaissance-strike complex. To do that you need things that cannot be attacked easily by reconnaissance-strike complex. So you want stealthy means of attack, stealthy aircraft launched from secure bases that will attack his reconnaissance-strike complex in Moscow with non-nuclear means.

Set up a water-cooled, belt-fed machine gun in the corridors of the Pentagon supplied liberally with ammunition

Politically, then, should we be opening up with them as much?

Well, I don't think we control this process. If a Soviet leader wants to be nice, the American leader has to be nice. Simple, because there's still a nice American presumption that we're the guys in the white hats. French public opinion understands when the French President chooses to be nasty to a Soviet leader who wants to be nice. They understand that he wants to be nice because he wants something; if you keep being nasty to him, he'll give you even more. They understand that; the Americans don't. And that's a fact. And I don't think it does any great harm.

STOP
CONTINENTAL
DRIFT

The Problems of the Nuclear-Free Zone

Kevin Dayton

The small South Pacific island nation of New Zealand is no superpower. Its major economic activity is raising sheep. Most Americans probably do not believe New Zealand could damage United States security. However, within the last five years the State Department and the military began to worry about it. How could such a small country hurt the United States?

New Zealand's environmentalists have been a source of conflict between the two countries. The high level of environmental activity led Greenpeace to put its headquarters in New Zealand. The environmentalists seek to keep nuclear devices out of the country, fearing that a nuclear-powered or nuclear-armed ship could strike a reef in one of the major harbors and contaminate the water.

Furthermore, New Zealand has its share of pacifists. Because of its relative isolation in the South Pacific, New Zealand may serve as a possible refuge from nuclear war. Since the 1960s a small but steady stream of North American pacifists has fled to the country, hoping to escape nuclear war. French above-ground nuclear testing in the South Pacific has scared many New Zealanders into pacifism. The former New Zealand Prime Minister David Lange became a nuclear opponent after seeing in the night sky the vivid glow caused by a French nuclear test explosion.

In 1984 enough voters opposed nuclear devices in New Zealand to allow the Labor Party to gain control of Parliament on an anti-nuclear platform. Soon, New Zealand became a "nuclear-free zone." Nuclear powered and nuclear-armed ships were banned from entering its harbors. To enforce the nuclear-free zone, New Zealand required all ships making port calls to declare whether or not they were nuclear-armed or nuclear-powered.

The U.S. State Department and the U.S. Navy were outraged. The nuclear-free zone is a violation of the Australia-New Zealand-United States defense treaty (ANZUS). All American naval vessels, regardless of their nuclear capabilities, stopped making port calls in New Zealand, because the United States Navy does not confirm or deny the presence of nuclear weapons on its ships as a matter of policy. Admiral James Lyons, Commander in Chief of the American Pacific fleet, said, "I would find it very difficult to ask men and women of the fleet to fight for a country which won't even let us visit in peacetime." In 1985, the United States cut off the sharing of intelligence data, reduced military personnel exchanges, and halted joint military exercises. In 1986, the United States declared that it was no longer committed to defending New Zealand, and reduced New Zealand to the lowest class of American allies. ANZUS is now virtually nullified.

The American reaction to New Zealand's anti-nuclear policy has not discouraged the Labor Party. Last April, then Prime Minister David Lange delivered a major foreign policy address at Yale. Lange affirmed his commitment to maintaining a nuclear-free zone despite the deterioration of relations between the two countries. Lange resigned last August for reasons unrelated to the nuclear-free zone controversy, however, the new Prime Minister, Geoffrey Palmer, has no plans for changing the nuclear policy of New Zealand. New Zealand has attempted to compensate for the loss of American military assistance through a costly

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military buildup. There is a high rate of attrition among New Zealand military officers, who have found themselves deprived of American high-tech military equipment.

The importance of a nuclear foreign policy issue in New Zealand politics is a "surprising and perplexing development," asserts General William Odom, Adjunct Professor of Political Science. The Labor Party appears to be supporting both the importance of the military alliance and the nuclear-free zone by claiming that the ANZUS security arrangement can be continued with solely conventional forces. A 1987 poll showed that roughly the same percentage of New Zealanders support a nuclear-free zone as those who advocate a continuing alliance with the United States (72% and 73% respectively). Although no poll has been taken, the majority of New Zealanders would likely select the continuation of the alliance if they were forced to choose between the two.

This attempt to remove New Zealand from the nuclear world by refusing port entry to nuclear-armed and nuclear-powered ships demonstrates the relatively new feeling of independence that has developed among its people. Robin Winks, expert in New Zealand history, explains that New Zealand was less eager for independence from Great Britain than other Commonwealth nations. Because New Zealand's independence evolved without violence, there is no definite moment at which the country could be declared spiritually "independent." New Zealanders are consequently sensitive to any perceived violations of their sovereignty. This insecurity may have contributed to the breakdown of negotiations between the United States and New Zealand when the United States pressured New Zealand to conform to the conditions of the ANZUS treaty.

The inability of United States naval ships to enter New Zealand harbors only inconveniences naval operations, and not a major problem for American nuclear deterrence strategy. There was nothing militarily crucial in New Zealand when the government established the nuclear-free zone, and other than monitoring stations for the manned Apollo missions, New Zealand has never played a significant role in American operations. Despite the Soviet gain of commercial fishing rights from newly independent island nations in the South Pacific such as Kiribati, and Libya's role in a military coup in Fiji in May, 1987, the South Pacific does not appear to be a potential trouble zone for the United States. New Zealand's isolationist conduct, which Lange described as "a regional perspective in place of a global perspective," seems plausible on the surface because a substantial naval presence in the South Pacific is not necessary and because Australia continues to patrol the area.

The United States is afraid, however, that the nuclear-free zone could set a precedent to be follwed by countries with greater strategies and importance. Europe and the Middle-East could pose a risk to American security interests. Political Science Professor Bradford Westerfield believes that a spirit of colonial emancipation in the Philippines, the site of a major American naval base for nuclear powered and armed vessels, could motivate that country to adopt a nuclear-free zone policy. Many people in Australia and Japan, also important for American naval operations, hold strong anti-nuclear sentiments and could elect a government eager to follow the example of New Zealand.

If these three Pacific countries adopted an anti-nuclear policy, the United States would probably have to limit naval bases to American-possessed Guam. This would be a costly inconvenience and would put the large Pacific fleet at a strategic disadvantage. Fortunately, Australia's current ruling party supports the ANZUS treaty and is not in danger of losing power, making Australia a possible alternative for a major American naval base if the Philippines acted against American naval interests. Even so, with the loss of the Philippines as a site for a naval base the United States would have to spend several billion dollars to build a seaport facility in Australia.

Right now the best way for the United States to protect its own concerns is to avoid doing anything that would upset the tenuous relations between the two countries. Aside from repudiating responsibility for defending New Zealand, the United States has made its displeasure with New Zealand obvious by not allowing former Prime Minister Lange to visit President Bush. The United States does not want to appear to sanction New Zealand's anti-nuclear policy by discussing the continuation of ANZUS as a purely conventional force arrangement. Considering the state of diplomatic relations between the two countries, it is anyway that Lange believed he would be able to

get an invitation to Washington in any case. Perhaps one of the major reasons Lange accepted an invitation to give a speech at Yale was to try to build a more tolerant attitude for his policies among a small group of intellectuals interested in New Zealand.

Reacting to the location of Lange's speech, New Zealand newspapers such as the New Zealand Herald and the Aulkland Star suggested that the Prime Minister was unnecessarily provocative in selecting George Bush's alma mater to give his speech. Even more ironically, Lange gave the speech as the speaker of the annual George Herbert Walker, Jr. Lecture in International Studies, which gives world leaders an opportunity to speak at Yale. The lecture is supported by a fund provided by a close family friend of the Bushes and relative of Barbara Bush. Ostensibly Lange accepted the Yale invitation because he wanted to recognize the work of Yale anthropologist Sir Peter Buck. If provocation was Lange's intent, he did not mention it publicly. The U.S. State Department had no public response to the speech.

Some Congressmen and top military officials have suggested threatening New Zealand with economic sanctions in order to force the government to abandon the nuclear-free zone. The United States can not risk using such threats, however, because New Zealand has the potential to cause serious problems for the United States. New Zealand could portray itself to the world as a martyr by claiming to be a victim of American oppression, or find alternative trading partners and leave the United States without a formerly receptive market for American exports.

Most seriously, New Zealand could weaken other American alliances. When David Lange was re-elected in 1987, he called New Zealand a beacon, and urged other countries to create nuclear-free zones. So far, however, Lange has avoided actively trying to persuade other countries to adopt anti-nuclear policies. During the question and answer session following his Yale address, Lange denied that New Zealand had a "missionary impulse" to encourage nuclear-free zones in other countries. Economic sanctions might motivate Lange to spite the United States by encouraging other American allies to adopt a nuclear-free zone as an act of sovereignty.

New Zealand could also react to economic sanctions by abandoning the ANZUS treaty altogether. Although the military commitments have been nullified, the tripartite treaty is officially still in existence. If the ANZUS treaty were formally abandoned by New Zealand, it might be more difficult to negotiate a new treaty if the National Party, opponent of the nuclear-free zone, regains a majority in Parliament.

Unfortunately, as the Labor party continues to control Parliament the possibility of resurrecting the ANZUS pact appears more remote. Geoffrey Palmer seems to be continuing the rupture David Lange began. It is possible, however, that the Labor Party could be defeated in the next election, if it is forced to take a stand on keeping a nuclear-free zone as opposed to keeping an alliance with the United States. Even if this does not occur, the people of New Zealand may eventually decide that an anti-nuclear position does not serve the long term interests of New Zealand. In addition to the nuclear-free zone controversy and the debate over New Zealand's future in ANZUS, Maori land claims, Australia-New Zealand relations, and the economy were major issues in the last Parliamentary election, and are still relevant now. Perhaps economic dissatisfaction will allow voters to make a decision without dealing with the sensitive issue of the nuclear-free zone.

Many New Zealanders are genuinely surprised about the American reaction to the nuclear-free zone. There is a strong pro-American attitude in New Zealand, demonstrated by the status of the United States as New Zealand's number one trading partner, the abandonment of the British university system for the American system, and the broadcasting of American television shows. There is also concern about the diplomatic rift between the two countries because of New Zealand's "long-range apprehensions" about being absorbed by Australia and becoming an island province like Tasmania, a fear equivalent to Canada's concern about becoming an extension of the United States. The lack of a security commitment would dissuade the United States from defending New Zealand if a confrontation occurred. A threat from their current ally Australia may seem more realistic for New Zealanders than involvement in a superpower conflict, especially because Canada's annexation of Newfoundland in 1949 provides a precedent for one Commonwealth country to annex another.

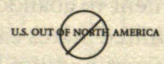
The Labor administration may be

viewed by New Zealanders in the future as an unfortunate development for three reasons. One negative result of the anti-nuclear policy is that New Zealand is becoming subordinate to Australia in international security circles, a concern for New Zealanders wanting to keep up with Australia to prevent becoming governed by it. Secondly, New Zealand is being deprived of valuable intelligence information once provided by the United States.

Finally, although in theory the idealistic anti-nuclear policy is supposed to remove New Zealand from the nuclear threat, in reality it could ironically make New Zealand more likely to be a target of Soviet missiles. During the 1987 elections National Party leader Jim Folger accurately described the nuclear-free zone as "an exercise in futility." A nuclear-free zone will not stop a ship determined to find safety during a nuclear war. It is possible that in the event of a nuclear war American or even Soviet ships would go to New Zealand to avoid destruction, along with other people resolved to survive by making New Zealand a strategically realistic target.

The government of New Zealand currently creates the impression that New Zealand would only suffer from social and economic problems after unrestricted nuclear war in the Northern hemisphere. In late 1987 the Department of the Environment released "After Nuclear War," the findings of a study which gained a lot of public attention in New Zealand. The report claimed that the worst effects of nuclear war would be the loss of trading partners and imported products, and that radioactive fallout and climatic changes would be mainly confined to the Northern hemisphere. It also concentrated on social consequences of nuclear war: unemployment, disruption of health services, and damage to transportation and communication services. The report upheld the nuclear-free zone by making people believe that nuclear immunity is realistic. In addition to government publications, privately written handbooks such as "A Nuclear Survival Manual for New Zealanders" perpetuate the idea of nuclear immunity by giving instructions for finding drinking water and digging latrines, and seriously discussing whether to hide from other survivors or to fight them.

The United States government hopes that New Zealand will get rid of the nuclear-free zone. New Zealand does have roles to play in international affairs, such as monitoring the South Pacific fishing grounds, providing hurricane relief to island nations, and keeping military units in Singapore and Malaysia. However, being the vanguard of a "nuclear-free zone" movement is detrimental for New Zealand and the United States. Such a policy threatens the Western alliance system, the balance of superpowers, and even the nuclear immunity of New Zealand itself. The best thing the United States can do now is to avoid altering the current situation and wait for either the Labor Party to back down or New Zealanders to make a change themselves through the polls.



Review

Frederick Kagan

Perestroika, *Mikhail Gorbachev, 1985*

Perestroika, Mikhail Gorbachev's first (1985) public outline of the program of reform in the Soviet Union, is singular in its ambiguity. From the first page to the last several strains of thought compete for dominance. The book appeared simultaneously in English and Russian in the United States and the Soviet Union, and it is aimed at two distinct audiences, one internal and one external.

The most easily understood audience is that of the average Western intellectual. It is clear that, insofar as the book is designed for the Western audience, it is designed to influence those who influence Western policy. It speaks knowledgably and with an assumption of knowledge on the part of the reader of current international affairs and the reports of reforms in the Soviet Union. Gorbachev refers often to the "Hand of Moscow *" and not less than five times to the "evil empire" speech by former President Reagan. It is clear that he felt it necessary on the one hand to dispel the "myth" of the "Hand of Moscow" and, on the other, to register his indignation at the epithet "evil empire." I will return to examine the deeper significance of this momentarily, but clearly these are burning questions only in the intellectual and policy circles of the West.

The second audience is the audience of the Soviet Union. This public, however, is more complex and any analysis of it requires certain assumptions about the actual nature of the reforms. If we posit that Gorbachev represents the interests and desires of the Soviet leadership as a whole and that the "hard-liners" who "oppose" the reforms are actually actors, pretending to hold views which they do not for Western consumption, then we must assume that this work reveals a fundamental hypocrisy. If there are no real "hard-liners," there is no need to placate them with "hard-line" statements, with strong rhetoric about the United States or Reagan's aggressive policies. As far as the Western audience is concerned, the work is primarily conciliatory. If Gorbachev does not need "hard-line" rhetoric, plainly counterproductive as regards the West, to win over "hard-line" opposition, then either such rhetoric represents his true feelings or he is a fool.

Before addressing the question of the role of Europe in Soviet foreign policy, Gorbachev allows himself an extended historical diatribe to demonstrate the central role of the Soviet Union in the Second World War, her unequalled sacrifice and the unmatched valor of her arms.

> *Our people laid the greatest sacrifices at the altar of the liberation struggle against Hitler's fascism. More than twenty million Soviet people died in that terrible war.*

Whether or not this statment is true, why should it have appeared in this work at all? When Prime Minister Thatcher "told me something to [the] effect" that "the Soviet Union joined in the fight against Nazi Germany 'only' in 1941, whereas before that the others had to fight Hitler 'single-handed'...I objected...". He cites as an example Soviet assistance to the Republicans fighting against the Nazi-supported Francoist forces in the Spanish Civil War. Gorbachev does not intend to convince Prime Minister Thatcher of the importance of the Soviet contribution, nor does he include this

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section to convince the people of the West. Had that been his goal, he need not have included Mrs. Thatcher's statement at all—he need merely have elaborated on the Soviet effort. His inclusion of Mrs. Thatcher's statement, however, indicates either that it stung him or that he felt it necessary to demonstrate to his own "loyal opposition" that he is actively fighting to maintain the correct image of Soviet power and glory before the world.

More telling, however, is his adoption of the standard Stalinist revisionism of the pre-war history. He brushes aside the Molotov-Ribbentrop pact saying "it could have been avoided...if the ruling circles of Britain and France had agreed to cooperate with the Soviet Union against the aggressor at that time." He then repeats the accusation Stalin levelled against the West right up until the Normandy invasion and even afterwards, that "the British rulers had only one thought on their minds: how to turn Hitler against the East, against the Soviet Union, and how to crush communism." Again, the question does not concern the accuracy of this historical analysis, but its presence in the book at all. The West, unlike the Soviet Union, does not any longer focus much attention on the Second World War. With his keen sense of Western politics, it is surprising that he should suddenly raise this issue simply for the purpose of annoying the West. In adopting the Stalinist rhetoric so thoroughly, furthermore, Gorbachev openly attacks Britain—a position he is very loath to take in the rest of his work even when it would be appropriate. Britain, after all, was the chief villain of colonialism, yet she escapes lightly in the sections of the book dealing with the effects of colonization.

The Bolshevik Revolution produced only continuity

The answer to the question "why are these statements here?" is twofold. First of all, we must reject the view of a monolithic Soviet leadership. Many reasons, which I will discuss later, support an alternative view , and I will posit, for the moment, that there are, in fact, Soviet "hard-liners" who more or less oppose these particular reforms and whom Gorbachev feels he must appease to some degree. The section described above is evidence of such appeasement. Soviet nationalism bridles at the suggestion that the Soviet Union was not almost single-handedly responsible for the downfall of Hitler. Many of the "hard-liners" are war veterans, either actual military men or commissars, and very little appeals to their sensebilities more than discussions of Soviet valor in the war and the crimes of the Westerners who are continually, as they see it, trying to steal from them their just praise. This section should please them. By bringing up this issue and supporting them unequivocally, Gorbachev hopes to win their support or stem their resistance. It is hard to see what other reason he could have for inserting this diatribe which, whatever else, is insulting and offensive to the West.

The situation, however, is more complicated still. Though appeasement of the "hard-liners" more or less explains this passage, it does not explain the five-odd references to Reagan's "evil empire" speech or the continuous attacks on the American "military-industrial complex." The reader has not proceeded thirteen pages into the book before he is confronted with the "evil empire" metaphor. "Sometimes we are not only disappointed but have serious misgivings when in the United States our country is treated as an aggressor, an 'empire of evil.'" The Presidential speech from which that metaphor was taken was not important—it did not enunciate a new policy against the Soviet Union, it did not have great influence in the West after the small furor it caused died down. Why does it appear five times in the course of this book? (It appears on pages 13, 128, 215, 221, and 232) Clearly it touched upon a very sensitive topic with Gorbachev.

One of the continuing themes of this book is that the peoples of the world and, particularly of the industrialized West, must respect the Soviet Union. "...The Soviet Union is a mighty devloped state and a well-educated nation with a vast intellectual potential." "...We, the Soviet leadership, know that there is nothing which the US could achieve that our scientists and engineers could not." Why this continual reaffirmation of the prowess of the Soviet Union? Throughout the centuries, one of the recurrent themes of Russian history has been the demand for recognition of Russia's status as a European power, as an equal to Britain and France. In this respect, the Bolshevik Revolution produced only continuity. One of the causes of Khruschev's downfall was his uncouth character and the damage this did to the Soviet Union's international image. Gorbachev recognizes that the stern tactics Brezhnev alternated with détante do not produce the kind of respect he seeks. They may or may not produce fear in the West, but they do not lead to

the feeling of equality he so keenly desires. The reason has always been that the Soviet leadership has purchased military excellence at the price of economic and social backwardness. Part of the drive behind perestroika is the desire to rectify this situation—to attain economic and social as well as politico-military success and respect in the West. What sort of respect can exist if the President of the United States refers to the Soviet Union as an "evil empire?"

Two "revisions" of Soviet military doctrine are apparent in spite of the obscurity. The first is Gorbachev's conclusions that a) nuclear war at this level of nuclear force is unwinnable and b) that war has therefore ceased to be a continuation of politics. "The fundamental principle of the new political outlook is very simple," he writes, "*nuclear war cannot be a means of achieving political, economic, ideological, or any other goals.*" Exactly how revolutionary this revision is can be judged by examining pre-1985 Soviet doctrine: "...no matter what war we take, *even a possible thermonuclear one*, as regards essence, they all were and will be a continuation of politics by means of armed force." Gorbachev justifies this revision by reference to the potential for destruction embodied in the new weapons: "There would be neither winners nor losers in a global nuclear conflict: world civilization would inevitably perish. It is a suicide, rather than a war in the conventional sense of the word."

The revolution embodied in this change of doctrine has profound implications. In 1970 in a work entitled *The Offensive*, the section on "The Nature of the Offensive Under Conditions Where Nuclear Weapons are Employed" begins: "*Nuclear weapons* are the most powerful means for mass destruction of troops and rear area objectives." It concludes that, "Thanks to this, the troops can conduct the offensive at high rates and achieve the assigned goals in short times." The turnaround is dramatic. Gorbachev has taken a large body of Soviet military doctrine, arrived at, by all accounts, scientifically, and thrown it away.

There is no objective military change with which to justify the conclusion that while previously nuclear war was winnable, it is no longer. There are two possible interpretations. One is that Gorbachev, on close examination of the problem, has concluded that all previous theorists were wrong, nuclear war has always been unwinnable, and the Soviet Union, like the United States, has been following a foolish, irresponsible strategy. The other alternative is that he is lying or, at least, overstating the case.

The reason nuclear war is unwinnable, according to Gorbachev, is because it would destroy world civilization. The immense number of nuclear weapons, he argues, makes this inevitable. Two solutions emerge: removing all nuclear weapons removes the threat of any nuclear war, but removing only some might reduce the arsenals to the point where an exchange would not destroy world civilization. In other words, if the numbers declined, the world would become safe for nuclear war. No "new thinking" is needed to justify this course of action. If, in fact, the arsenals are so large that nuclear war cannot be won, then they are useless militarily. They may or may not have political value, but that value is bound, in any case, to decrease as their military inutility is more widely recognized. If an army possesses a large number of weapons which it cannot use, it might naturally attempt to change the situation so that it can use them. A diplomatic offensive, therefore, might simply be an effort to restore political and military utility to a weapon in danger of rendering itself obsolete.

The interpretation outlined above presumes that Gorbachev is lying; that he is not interested in doing away with nuclear war, but, on the contrary, aims to make it feasible again. Taking his word, however, a different picture emerges. The reason war is no longer a continuation of politics, according to Perestroika, is that it would be suicide. If we do away with nuclear weapons, war is no longer suicide and conventional war would become feasible. As it stands now, Soviet doctrine, which Gorbachev has not revised, maintains that any major war between the superpowers is likely to escalate rapidly to the thermonuclear stage. If that stage vanished, the world would be safe for conventional war. A quick glance at the geo-strategic map of the world shows that the Soviet Union is at a distinct advantage if the war is purely conventional. Europe is likely to be a key theater and they can get there much faster than we can and in much greater force.

The second doctrinal shift is the change to a defensive strategy with arms levels determined by the principle of reasonable sufficiency, "that is, a level necessary for strictly defensive purposes." Is this really a change in Soviet doctrine? "Never, under any circumstances, will our country begin military operations against Western Europe unless we and our allies are

Gorbachev has taken a large body of Soviet military doctrine, arrived at, by all accounts, scientifically, and thrown it away.

attacked by NATO!" This is not news. It has been a long time since the Soviet leadership contemplated an unprovoked offensive against the West—probably not since Stalin. Soviet manpower levels and military effort have always been justified by reference to the "imperialist aggressors" who continually spur on the arms race. Tyushkyevich spends three pages laying out the improvements, enlargements, and aggressions of the "imperialist" forces and then concludes "Naturally all this has obliged and is obliging the Soviet Union to implement the necessary countermeasures." The claim that Soviet policy is now "defensive" is not a doctrinal shift.

If "reasonable sufficiency" is interpreted to mean a rejection of the Soviet strategy of seizing the offensive, possibly by preemption, it would, indeed, represent a shift. *The Offensive* spends many pages outlining the advantages of seizing and holding the offensive, and Soviet doctrine for years has relied on the lesson of the Second World War that the offensive is necessary for success. If Gorbachev has forced the army to abandon this doctrine and plan to fight a purely defensive war, he has produced a large change. On the other hand, he may have produced no change at all. Previously the Soviet army could expect to launch an invasion of Western Europe following a buildup which would last x days. If Gorbachev's reforms mean that the buildup must now last $x+y$ days before Western Europe can be invaded, he has not made a doctrinal or even a strategic shift. The evidence, here as elsewhere, is ambiguous.

Gorbachev's work raises many questions, but does not answer them. Written for two distinct, large, and nebulous audiences, it is full of ambiguity and imprecision. Gorbachev declares that the 27th Party Congress rejected the old definiton of "peaceful co-existence," but does not tell us what the new definition. The two major doctrinal shifts presented in the work may or may not be important in the long run, but there is no way to judge from *Perestroika*. Examination of other evidence in an effort to clarify some of these points is necessary, but the task does not offer much hope of reward.

* "The Hand of Moscow" was a catchphrase current in the 1970s which referred to the seemingly ubiquitous influence of the Soviet Union in the Third World.

In Memoriam

A. Bartlett Giamatti
1938-1989

The Staff of the
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expresses its sympathy
with those who knew and loved him.

He gave much
to the Yale community
and to us
and we shall miss him.

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❦

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❦

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